

DECISION REQUIRED	As SBTDWS develops the Multi Domain Training Centre (MDTC), does the current desert warfare course programme remain the main output, or does the MDTC become the main output with the course programme reduced to an agreed core?	
COA 1 — RETAIN AND ADD Keep the current focus. Build the MDTC alongside it. What it means - SBTDWS keeps the desert warfare focus and the full course programme as its main output. - The MDTC is developed as a second, separate output of the same organisation. What it costs - Additional manpower on top of current establishment. - New expertise required: Observer Trainers, scenario design, EXCON / HICON, LVC. - A second budget line and additional facility capacity. Main risk - Two outputs delivered by one organisation. If the manpower bid is not met in full, both outputs are weakened and the MLOC / IOC / FOC dates are not achievable. Required before this COA can be adopted - Full manpower and budget uplift approved before Q4 26.	COA 2 — PROGRESSIVE PIVOT The MDTC becomes the main output over time. What it means - The MDTC becomes the main output. The course programme is reduced to an agreed core. - Remaining courses are either stopped or handed to another organisation. What it costs - Fewer new posts. Existing staff, facilities and budget are re-tasked to the MDTC. - Course throughput to PG units falls during the change. Main risk - PG units lose course places before the MDTC is able to replace that output. - A change of this scope may require cover under the founding decree. Required before this COA can be adopted - Agreed list of courses to keep; named organisation to receive courses handed off; decree position confirmed.	COA 3 — HYBRID Keep a defined core. Reduce the remainder at each gate. <i>(assessed most likely outcome)</i> What it means - A defined desert warfare core is kept permanently. - The remainder of the course programme is reduced step by step, matched to what the MDTC can absorb at each gate. What it costs - Manpower uplift is smaller than COA 1 and is phased across the plan. - Requires a review and re-scoping activity at each gate. Main risk - Without agreed criteria for what is kept, each reduction becomes a separate argument rather than one endorsed plan. Required before this COA can be adopted - Standing authority to review and adjust the course programme at MLOC Q4 27, IOC Q4 28 and FOC Q4 30.
NOT PART OF THIS DECISION	- Desert warfare remains a permanent core competency of the institution. It is not removed under any option. - The founding decree, the institutional name and the heritage question are separate items already raised as RFI-1. - What is being decided is how much of the wider course programme is retained — not whether desert warfare training continues.	
WHAT WE NEED TO PROCEED	- Direction on which courses are protected and which may be reduced, stopped or handed over. - Authority to build the implementation plan against a reduced course programme after MLOC, subject to review at each gate. - A named organisation to receive any course handed off. - Confirmation that reduced course output during the change is understood and accepted at PG HQ level.	